Video 08 | Drum Sounds

Massive PSXL instructional series - video script

Runtime estimate	Narration length	Scenes	Format
about 5:24 minutes	765 words at 150 words per minute	12	Screen capture of the plug-in with voice-over; dark theme, interface size 125 percent

Learning goals

- Build a kick, snare, hats and clap from Load Init (Blank).
- Use OneShot envelopes, pitch envelopes and noise routing.
- Use a Performer to make a clap.

> **NOTE.** Accuracy rule for the narrator and any generated video: use the on-screen names exactly as written in the action column. After **Load Init (Blank)** the synth is silent until routing is connected. Do not compare Massive PSXL to other products.

Scene table

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
1	Load Init (Blank). Routing: draw Osc 1 > Filter 1, Filter 1 > Insert, Noise > Insert, Insert > Out.	Drums are short bursts of sine and noise. We start with a kick. After Load Init Blank, wire Osc 1 into Filter 1, Filter 1 into the Insert, Noise into the Insert, and the Insert into Out. The noise skips the filter so the click stays bright. Because the oscillator goes through filter one, you can use the filter to tame it, while the noise bypasses it for a clean click.	Show the final routing diagram while wires are drawn.
2	Osc 1: Morph Basic, Pos 0, Level 0.95. Noise: Level 0.10, Color 0.85. Filter 1 Cutoff 9000, Reso 0.05. Insert TanH Drive 0.25 Mix 1.0.	Set Osc 1 to a pure sine, level point nine five. Noise at point one, with Color up high so only the click remains. Filter one open at nine thousand. The Insert is TanH, drive a quarter, mix one. The insert with a mix of one makes the whole signal go through the saturation, adding harmonics to a kick that would otherwise be a plain sine, which helps it be heard on small speakers.	Hover readouts as each value is set.
3	Amp Env: Attack 0.001, Decay 0.28, Sustain 0, Release 0.08, OneShot on.	The amp envelope: attack one millisecond, decay point two eight, sustain zero, release point zero eight, and OneShot on. That means a tap plays the whole drum. Sustain at zero is important for drums, because it makes the sound die away by itself. Without OneShot, letting go of the key early would send the envelope into its release and cut the drum short.	Show OneShot toggle lighting.

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
4	Mod 2 (Envelope): Attack 0.0005, Decay 0.11, Sustain 0, Release 0.05, OneShot on. Drag chip onto Osc 1 Pitch; Edit amount +0.28. Play low notes C0 to C1.	Now the thump. Mod 2 is a very fast envelope. Drag its chip onto Osc 1 Pitch and set plus point two eight. The pitch starts about twenty-seven semitones up and falls in a tenth of a second. Play low notes. For a longer 808 kick, set Osc 1 Pitch to minus twelve, decay point nine. The decay of Mod 2 sets how fast the pitch drops. Shorter makes a clicky, tight kick; longer makes a deeper, boomier one. The amount sets how much extra pitch the attack has.	Pitch-sweep graph overlay. Show the keyboard lower register.
5	Load Init (Blank). Quick setup 'Noise > Filter 1 > Insert > Out (drums / FX)'; add Osc 1 > Filter 1.	Snare. Load Init Blank again and use the quick setup for drums and effects: Noise, into Filter 1, into the Insert, into Out. Then add a wire from Osc 1 to Filter 1 for the body.	Highlight the quick setup name.
6	Noise Level 0.9, Color 0.55. Osc 1 Pos 0, Pitch +12, Level 0.5. Filter 1: State Variable, BP, Cutoff 2400, Reso 0.35. Insert Fold Drive 0.2 Mix 1. Amp Env Attack 0.0008, Decay 0.22, Sustain 0, Release 0.05, OneShot.	Noise level point nine, with Color near the middle. Osc 1 as a sine an octave up at half level. Filter one: State Variable in band-pass mode, cutoff twenty-four hundred, reso point three five. Insert on Fold, then the same one-shot envelope with decay point two two. The state variable filter in band-pass mode is a very good snare shaper: lower the cutoff for a boxier snare, raise it for a snappier one.	Show the Mode menu and select BP.
7	Make hats: Load Init, same quick setup. Noise Level 0.9, Color 0.9. Filter 1 State Variable HP, Cutoff 9000. Amp Env: Decay 0.045, Release 0.05, OneShot. Save as Hat Closed; then Decay 0.35, Release 0.2 for Hat Open.	Hats are even simpler. Noise through a high-pass at nine thousand. Closed hat: decay forty-five milliseconds. Open hat: the same patch with decay point three five. There is no choke group, so keep open hats short enough for your tempo. You can make a shaker the same way, with a short hold and a slightly lower high-pass. And for something more metallic, try the Crackle noise type or a comb filter on the noise.	Side-by-side waveform for closed and open hats.
8	Load Init, same drum routing, Noise Level 0.9, Color 0.6; Filter 1 SVF BP 1500 Hz Reso 0.45; Amp Level 0; Amp Env Decay 0.16, OneShot.	Clap. Same routing again. Set the Amp Level knob to zero, because a Performer will supply the level. Filter one band-pass at fifteen hundred with some resonance, and a decay of point one six, OneShot on. Setting the Amp Level to zero seems odd, but the Performer will add the level back, step by step, which is exactly what we want for a series of hand claps.	Show Amp Level at 0.
9	Perf 1: Steps 6, Sync off, Rate 28 Hz, Smooth 0.3. Bars: 1, 0.05, 0.85, 0.05, 0.7, 0.35. Drag chip onto Amp Level; amount +0.8.	Open Perf 1. Six steps, sync off, twenty-eight hertz. Draw bars: full, almost nothing, high, almost nothing, a bit lower, then a tail. Drag it onto Amp Level at plus point eight. Each step is one hand, and the clap stutters before the tail. A Smooth of about thirty percent softens the edges of each hand, so the clap does not click. Longer smoothing gives a washy, softer clap.	Show the six bars highlighted one by one.
10	Reverb tab Mix 0.2 on the clap. Play all four sounds one after another by loading saved presets.	A little reverb makes it roomy. Finally, remember toms are just kicks with a higher pitch and a gentler sweep: pitch plus five, decay half a second. And the factory Drums category has all of these to compare. Toms are sines like kicks but pitched higher, with a shorter sweep and a longer tone. Play a fill up the keyboard and you have a tuned tom set.	Quick montage of a drum pattern in a DAW piano roll.
11	Show Browse > Drums category. Click Kick Tight, Snare Crack, Hat Closed, Clap Room.	Open Browse and the Drums category to compare: Kick Tight, Snare Crack, Hat Closed, Clap Room, Tom Low and more. Play around C zero to C three. Remember the drum presets use a OneShot amp envelope so a tap plays the whole hit. Play around C zero to C three. The preset list is a good place to compare your patch with ours.	Highlight each preset name as it is clicked.

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
12	End card.	Starting points, not rules: change decay times and cutoffs until the drums sit in your track. Next, bass sounds.	End card: 'Next: 09 Bass sounds'.

Narration only (plain script for text-to-speech or NotebookLM)

[Scene 1] Drums are short bursts of sine and noise. We start with a kick. After Load Init Blank, wire Osc 1 into Filter 1, Filter 1 into the Insert, Noise into the Insert, and the Insert into Out. The noise skips the filter so the click stays bright. Because the oscillator goes through filter one, you can use the filter to tame it, while the noise bypasses it for a clean click.

[Scene 2] Set Osc 1 to a pure sine, level point nine five. Noise at point one, with Color up high so only the click remains. Filter one open at nine thousand. The Insert is TanH, drive a quarter, mix one. The insert with a mix of one makes the whole signal go through the saturation, adding harmonics to a kick that would otherwise be a plain sine, which helps it be heard on small speakers.

[Scene 3] The amp envelope: attack one millisecond, decay point two eight, sustain zero, release point zero eight, and OneShot on. That means a tap plays the whole drum. Sustain at zero is important for drums, because it makes the sound die away by itself. Without OneShot, letting go of the key early would send the envelope into its release and cut the drum short.

[Scene 4] Now the thump. Mod 2 is a very fast envelope. Drag its chip onto Osc 1 Pitch and set plus point two eight. The pitch starts about twenty-seven semitones up and falls in a tenth of a second. Play low notes. For a longer 808 kick, set Osc 1 Pitch to minus twelve, decay point nine. The decay of Mod 2 sets how fast the pitch drops. Shorter makes a clicky, tight kick; longer makes a deeper, boomier one. The amount sets how much extra pitch the attack has.

[Scene 5] Snare. Load Init Blank again and use the quick setup for drums and effects: Noise, into Filter 1, into the Insert, into Out. Then add a wire from Osc 1 to Filter 1 for the body.

[Scene 6] Noise level point nine, with Color near the middle. Osc 1 as a sine an octave up at half level. Filter one: State Variable in band-pass mode, cutoff twenty-four hundred, reso point three five. Insert on Fold, then the same one-shot envelope with decay point two two. The state variable filter in band-pass mode is a very good snare shaper: lower the cutoff for a boxier snare, raise it for a snappier one.

[Scene 7] Hats are even simpler. Noise through a high-pass at nine thousand. Closed hat: decay forty-five milliseconds. Open hat: the same patch with decay point three five. There is no choke group, so keep open hats short enough for your tempo. You can make a shaker the same way, with a short hold and a slightly lower high-pass. And for something more metallic, try the Crackle noise type or a comb filter on the noise.

[Scene 8] Clap. Same routing again. Set the Amp Level knob to zero, because a Performer will supply the level. Filter one band-pass at fifteen hundred with some resonance, and a decay of point one six, OneShot on. Setting the Amp Level to zero seems odd, but the Performer will add the level back, step by step, which is exactly what we want for a series of hand claps.

[Scene 9] Open Perf 1. Six steps, sync off, twenty-eight hertz. Draw bars: full, almost nothing, high, almost nothing, a bit lower, then a tail. Drag it onto Amp Level at plus point eight. Each step is one hand, and the clap stutters before the tail. A Smooth of about thirty percent softens the edges of each hand, so the clap does not click. Longer smoothing gives a washy, softer clap.

[Scene 10] A little reverb makes it roomy. Finally, remember toms are just kicks with a higher pitch and a gentler sweep: pitch plus five, decay half a second. And the factory Drums category has all of these to compare. Toms are sines like kicks but pitched higher, with a shorter sweep and a longer tone. Play a fill up the

keyboard and you have a tuned tom set.

[Scene 11] Open Browse and the Drums category to compare: Kick Tight, Snare Crack, Hat Closed, Clap Room, Tom Low and more. Play around C zero to C three. Remember the drum presets use a OneShot amp envelope so a tap plays the whole hit. Play around C zero to C three. The preset list is a good place to compare your patch with ours.

[Scene 12] Starting points, not rules: change decay times and cutoffs until the drums sit in your track. Next, bass sounds.

> **TIP.** Pause for about one second between scenes and let on-screen actions finish before the next sentence starts.